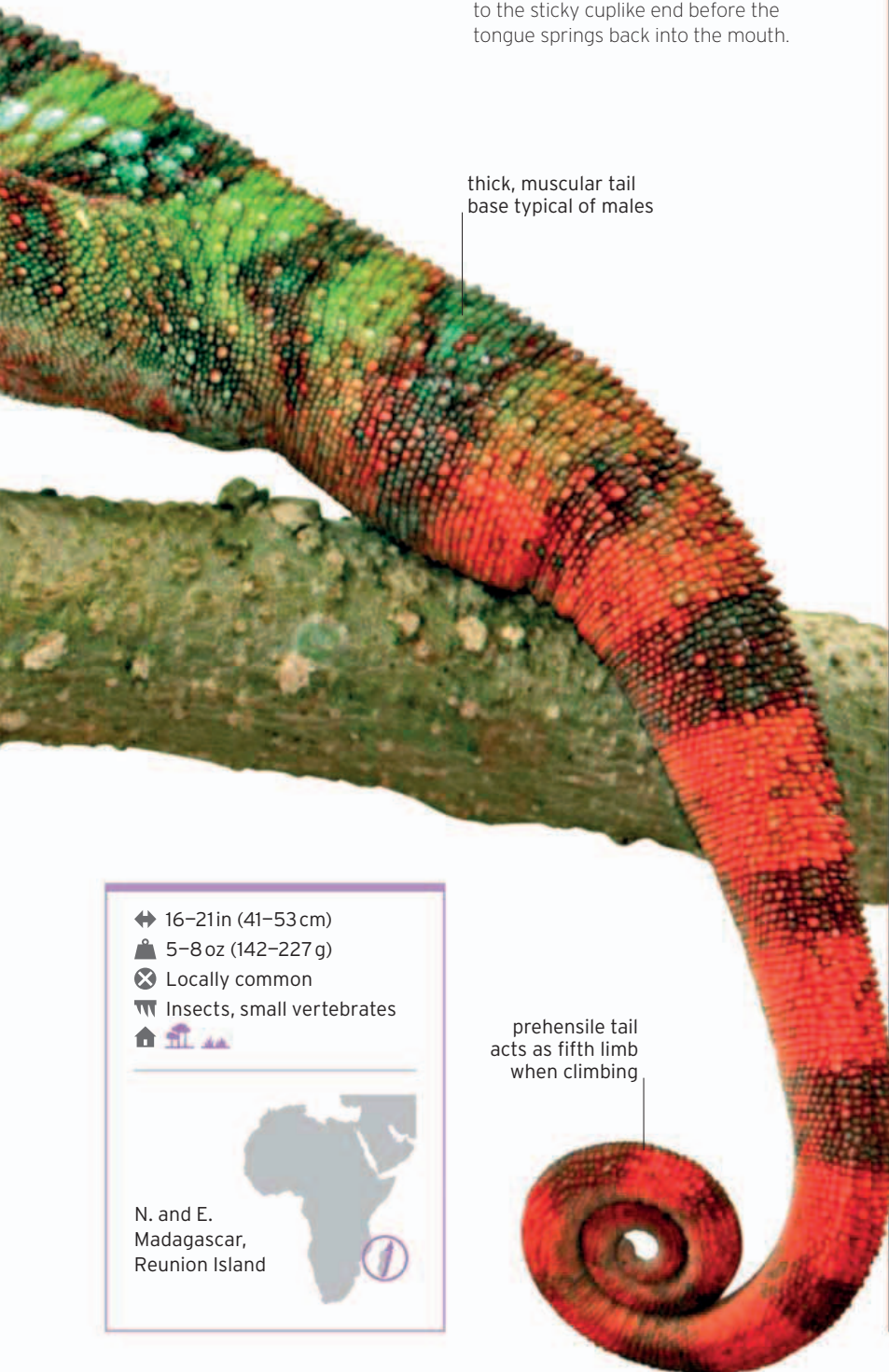




△ ON TARGET

The chameleon shoots out its elastic tongue onto the prey, which adheres to the sticky cuplike end before the tongue springs back into the mouth.



thick, muscular tail base typical of males

- ↔ 16–21 in (41–53 cm)
- ⚖ 5–8 oz (142–227 g)
- ⊗ Locally common
- 🐛 Insects, small vertebrates
- 🏠 🌳 🌴

N. and E.
Madagascar,
Reunion Island



prehensile tail acts as fifth limb when climbing

Henkel's leaf-tailed gecko

Uroplatus henkeli

large, triangular head



Henkel's leaf-tailed gecko's remarkable camouflage is heightened by the "frill" of skin along the sides of its head—giving it a "beard"—and part of its body. When resting during the day, lying flat on a mossy, lichen-covered rock or tree trunk, these features break up the otherwise recognizable lizard-shaped outline. It hunts at night, mainly for insects, usually several feet above ground.



△ STICKY TOES

Henkel's gecko's large, adhesive toe pads, typical of the gecko family, stick even to glossy leaves and crumbly bark and so help in climbing trees.

- ↔ 11 in (28 cm)
- ⚖ 1½–1¾ oz (40–50 g)
- ⊗ Vulnerable
- 🐛 Insects, snails
- 🏠 🌳 🌴
- 📍 N. and W. Madagascar

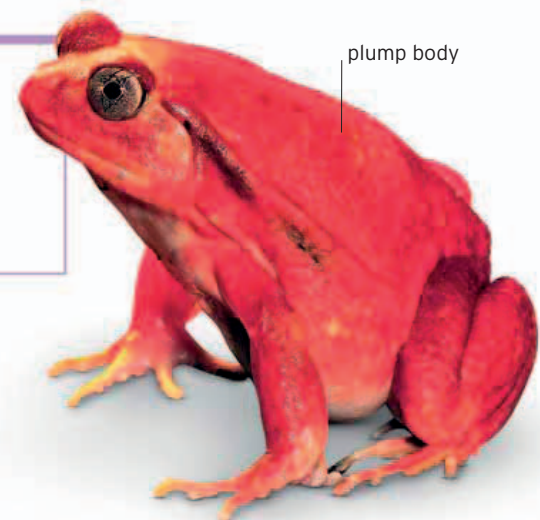
Tomato frog

Dyscophus antongilii

The tomato frog's bright orange-red skin is a warning to predators, such as snakes. When threatened, its first line of defense is to puff itself up to look larger, and this also makes it difficult to swallow. If taken into a predator's jaws, the frog exudes a sticky liquid from its skin that clogs up the attacker's mouth and inflames its skin. The liquid can cause swellings and rashes in humans.

- ↔ 2–4 in (5–10 cm)
- ☁ Rainy season
- ⊗ Near threatened
- 🐛 Insects
- 🏠 🌳 🌴
- 📍 N. and E. Madagascar

plump body



▷ RED ALERT

Female tomato frogs, such as the one shown here, are larger and more brightly colored than males.